Why Apple WANTS You to Touch Its iPhones

Angle: A — "The 30-second trap" (spot the trap), with B's Decathlon stat and C's touchscreen stat folded in

Target: ~8:30 · Words: ~1168 spoken · Style: STYLE.md v1.1 · Audience: India (₹)

> Every number carries its RESEARCH.md reference, e.g. `R3`. "Reportedly" stays wherever it's written:

> Apple has never confirmed the screen-angle story `F1`.

Hook options (pick one at recording; A1 is the default)

#	From	Cold-open line	Question
A1 ★	Angle A	"Ever noticed that in an Apple store, every iPhone is out on the table, unlocked, just waiting for you to pick it up? That's not a favour. Apple wants it in your hand. Because the moment you hold it, it starts to feel like yours."	"So why would 30 seconds of touching make you pay more?"
A2	Angle A	"Apple sold a record $9 billion in India last year `N1`. And part of that sale happened in your hands, before you paid."	"What happens in your head when you pick up an iPhone?"
B1	Angle B	"Decathlon gives you a free cricket pitch. And last year it lost ₹65 crore `R9`."	"So why would a store pay to let you play?"
C1	Angle C	"Shopping on your phone can make you value a product about 50% more than shopping on a laptop `R4`."	"How does a glass screen make something feel like yours?"

The script below is written for **A1**. If you record A2/B1/C1, only sections 1–2 change.

1 · Cold open — the result (0:00–0:05)

Ever noticed that in an Apple store, every iPhone is out on the table, unlocked, just waiting for you to pick it up? That's not a favour. Apple wants it in your hand. Because the moment you hold it, it starts to feel like yours.

> *B-ROLL: Apple Store interior, laptops on wooden tables — licensed stock, search "apple store laptops table" · NEWS N1: Inc42, "Apple's India Sales Hit Record $9 Bn Mark In FY25", highlight: "record $9 Bn" · ANNOTATE: red-pen circle on a hand picking up an iPhone, handwritten "feels like yours" · SFX: whoosh + shutter*

2 · The question (0:05–0:12)

So why would thirty seconds of touching something make you pay more for it?

> *PUNCH-IN · Caption highlight: "thirty seconds" · SFX: soft hit*

3 · Why it matters to you (0:12–0:25)

Because it's happening to you every week. In the Apple store. At Decathlon. And on the shopping app in your pocket. By the end of this video, you'll spot the trap, and know the one rule that beats it.

> *ANIM: three icons pop in a row — apple-store bag, cricket bat, phone with a cart; red-pen circle lands on the phone · SFX: pop ×3*

4 · Chapter 1 — The mug that doubled in price (0:25–2:15)

ANALOGY

Think about a rented flat versus your own flat. Same walls. Same tiles. But the day you hang your family photo on that wall, a cracked tile stops being 'the landlord's problem'. It becomes *my* tile. Nothing changed about the tile. Only one thing changed. It feels like yours.

> *ANIM: a flat outline; a photo frame slides onto the wall; the label on a tile flips from "landlord's" to "MINE" with a highlighter sweep*

HOW IT REALLY WORKS

Economists call this the endowment effect. Once something feels like ours, we value it more. Because giving it up now feels like a loss. And our brains hate losses more than they love equal gains.

> *SLIDE: two-sided scale — "Gain ₹100" on one side, "Lose ₹100" on the other; the loss side drops lower · TEXT CARD: "Endowment effect = it's mine, so it's worth more"*

PROOF

In 1990, three researchers, one of them later a Nobel winner, ran a simple test at Cornell University. They gave plain coffee mugs to half the students, at random. Then they asked: owners, what would you sell it for? Everyone else, what would you pay? The owners wanted about seven dollars. The buyers offered about three. Same mug. More than double the price. Just because it was in their hands. R1

> *ANIM: classroom split in two; mugs drop onto half the desks · STAT: ~$7 vs ~$3 · Sellers vs buyers, same mug · Source: Kahneman, Knetsch & Thaler, J. Political Economy, 1990 · ANNOTATE: red circle on "$7" · SFX: ping*

OBJECTION

Now you might be thinking: maybe the owners just liked mugs more? That's the clever bit. The mugs were handed out at random. Owners and buyers were the same kind of students. The only difference was who was holding one. To be fair, later researchers showed part of that gap comes from how the test was run. But the effect keeps showing up, and it's strongest for things you can touch.

> *TEXT CARD: "Maybe the owners just liked mugs more?"*

RE-HOOK

Here's the crazy part. You don't need to own it. You don't even need to hold it for long. F3

> *SFX: soft hit · PUNCH-IN*

✂ REEL 1: 0:25–1:35 · hook card: "Same mug. Double the price."

4 · Chapter 2 — Thirty seconds in your hand (2:15–4:30)

HOW IT REALLY WORKS

So how long does it take for something to feel like yours? In 2008, researchers tested it with 144 people and, again, a coffee mug. Some held the mug for ten seconds. Others held it for thirty. Then everyone bid for it in a real auction, with real money. The thirty-second group bid significantly more. R3 Just twenty extra seconds in their hands. And a second study went further. Simply touching a product makes you feel you own it, and makes you willing to pay more for it. Even when it isn't yours. R2

> *ANIM: two hands holding identical mugs; timers over each, 0:10 and 0:30; the 30-second hand's bid tag rises higher · STAT: 30 seconds · Enough touch to raise your bid · Source: Wolf, Arkes & Muhanna, 2008 · SFX: ping · TEXT CARD: "Touch → 'mine' → pay more" · Peck & Shu, 2009*

PROOF

Now walk into an Apple store. Every iPhone, every Mac, every iPad is out. Unlocked. No security box. Staff don't rush you. Retail watchers say even the laptop screens are tilted to the same angle every morning, so you reach out and fix them. F1 And it works. In 2023, each Apple store in India was reported to be selling twenty-two to twenty-five crore rupees a month. R8

> *B-ROLL: Apple BKC / Saket exterior and interior — licensed stock or self-shot · STAT: ₹22–25 cr · Monthly sales per Apple India store (2023) · Source: MyMobileIndia, 2023 · ANNOTATE: arrow to "per month"*

Decathlon does the same thing, but bigger. Cricket nets. Football cages. Basketball courts. Inside the store. You don't just touch the bat. You hit three shots with it. And now it's *your* bat. N4

> *B-ROLL: Decathlon India store play zone — licensed stock or self-shot · NEWS N4: Medianews4u, highlight: "use our play areas... cannot be fully replicated online"*

OBJECTION

But wait. If touch sells so well, everyone would do it, right? Here's the catch: it's expensive. Decathlon India made over four thousand crore in revenue last year. But it posted a loss of sixty-five crore. R9 Giant stores with sports courts cost a lot. So touch isn't free money. It's a bet that those thirty seconds pay for the floor space.

> *TEXT CARD: "If touch works, why doesn't every shop do it?" · NEWS N3: Entrackr, highlight: "Rs 65 cr loss" · STAT: ₹4,133 cr revenue · ₹65 cr loss · Decathlon India FY25 · Source: Entrackr (RoC filings) · ANNOTATE: red circle on "₹65 cr loss"*

RE-HOOK

And this trick is so old, a government once warned shoppers about it. In 2003, the Illinois Attorney General in the US warned holiday shoppers: watch out for salespeople who ask you to hold the product and imagine owning it. F2

> *TEXT CARD: "Don't let them put it in your hands." — 2003 warning, Illinois AG · SFX: typing*

✂ REEL 2: 2:15–3:25 · hook card: "Why Apple wants you to touch it"

✂ REEL 3: 3:50–4:30 · hook card: "Decathlon lost ₹65 crore doing this"

4 · Chapter 3 — Your phone fakes the touch (4:30–6:30)

ANALOGY

So what about online shopping? You can't touch a lipstick through Wi-Fi. Or can you? Think of it like a trial room mirror. The clothes aren't yours yet. But the mirror shows them on *you*. That's all online stores need.

> *ANIM: a trial-room mirror; a kurta appears on a silhouette; the mirror morphs into a phone screen*

HOW IT REALLY WORKS

The same study that showed touch builds ownership found something else. Just *imagining* you own it works too. And the researchers said it plainly: that's how online sellers can sell without touch. R2 So apps fake three things. Touch. Use. And imagining it's yours.

> *SLIDE: three columns — TOUCH (swipe, zoom) · USE (try-on, view in room) · IMAGINE ("Your bag", "Saved for you")*

PROOF

Start with touch. In one study, people shopping on a touchscreen valued products about fifty percent more than people using a mouse. Your finger on the glass is almost a hand on the product. R4 Then use. Myntra says its virtual makeup try-on doubled conversions in makeup. R11 And in a survey for Snapchat, seventy-two percent of shoppers said they're more likely to buy after trying something on in AR. R13

> *ANIM: a finger swipes a sweatshirt on a phone; price tag inflates · STAT: ~50% · Higher value on touchscreen vs mouse · Source: Brasel & Gips, via Boston College · SFX: ping · STAT: 2× · Makeup conversions with virtual try-on · Source: Myntra (company figure) · STAT: 72% · More likely to buy after AR try-on · Source: Snap × Publicis survey, 2022*

And then imagine. Look at the words. Not 'cart'. *Your* bag. *Your* wishlist. *Saved for you.* The app is telling you it's already yours.

> *ANNOTATE: red-pen underline on "Your" in a mock app header "Your Bag (2)" · SFX: pen scratch*

OBJECTION

Now you might be thinking: if apps can fake it, why are shops still around? Because faking it has a bill. In Indian online fashion, around thirty to thirty-five percent of orders come back. And over forty percent of those returns are about size. R14 That's the cost of not letting you touch.

> *TEXT CARD: "If apps can fake it, why do stores exist?" · STAT: 30–35% · Fashion & footwear orders returned in India · Source: Return Prime, 2024 · ANNOTATE: circle "30–35%"*

RE-HOOK

But here's where it gets interesting. Amazon shut down its 'try before you buy' service in January 2025. F4 Warby Parker, the brand famous for posting you five frames to try at home, is ending that too. F5 Both are betting that AI try-on is now good enough. The fake touch is replacing the real one.

> *NEWS: eMarketer, "Warby Parker ... ends home try-on, bets on stores and eye exams" · SFX: whoosh*

✂ REEL 4: 4:30–5:50 · hook card: "Your phone makes you pay 50% more"

4 · Chapter 4 — Its cousins: trials and DIY (6:30–7:35)

The endowment effect has two cousins you've definitely met. One: the free trial. A month of no ads, and going back feels like losing something. One survey estimated seventy-two percent of Spotify trial users went on to pay. R15 Same with a hundred-night mattress trial. After a hundred nights, it's your bed. R17

> *ANIM: a calendar flips 30 days; an ad banner returns on day 31 and the face frowns · STAT: 72% · Spotify trial users who converted (survey estimate, 2018) · Source: CIRP · B-ROLL: mattress unboxing, licensed stock*

Two: the IKEA effect. Build it yourself, and you'll value it more. One study found people would pay about sixty-three percent more for furniture they'd assembled themselves. R5 Effort is just another way of making it yours.

> *ANIM: flat-pack box → assembled shelf; a "+63%" tag swings onto it · STAT: 63% · Extra people would pay for self-assembled furniture · Source: Norton, Mochon & Ariely · SFX: ping*

5 · Impact on you (7:35–8:40)

So what does this mean for your money? The price you're willing to pay isn't fixed. It rises the moment something feels like yours. Thirty seconds with a phone. Three shots with a bat. One swipe. One try-on. And the brand designed every one of those moments.

> *B-ROLL: a hand picking up a phone in a store; a hand swiping on a shopping app · ANIM: a "willingness to pay" meter climbing with each moment*

Here's the one rule that beats it: the twenty-four-hour rule. Put it down. Close the app. Decide tomorrow. When you're not holding it, the 'mine' feeling fades. And ask one question: would I buy this if I'd never touched it?

> *TEXT CARD: "The 24-hour rule" · ANIM: before/after — meter high while holding, meter drops after "put it down" · ANNOTATE: red-pen box around "Would I buy this if I'd never touched it?"*

✂ **REEL 5: 7:35–8:40 · hook card: "The rule that beats the Apple store"**

6 · Spot it yourself + debatable question (8:40–9:30)

Now you'll see it everywhere. The test drive where they say 'take it home for the weekend'. Lenskart and Nykaa putting the product on your face through your camera. IKEA showing the sofa in *your* living room. The free trial that needs your card. And the words 'your bag' every time you open an app.

> *B-ROLL / LOGOS: car showroom · Lenskart · Nykaa · IKEA · OTT trial screen · "Your Bag" header — logos only as editorial reference*

So here's my question. Is this smart selling, or is it manipulation? A: it's just good selling, you still choose. B: it's manipulation, stores should warn you, like Illinois did. Vote A or B in the comments.

> *POLL: "Clever selling or manipulation?" · A: Clever selling · B: Manipulation · ANNOTATE: arrow to "Vote A or B in the comments" · SFX: pop, pop*

Summary

• **Runtime estimate:** ~7:50 of speech (≈1168 spoken words at 150 wpm), ~8:20–8:40 with pauses on stat cards and news shots. Section timestamps above are planning estimates; /video-plan sets the real ones in SPEC.md.

• **Chapters:** 0:00 Cold open · 0:25 The mug that doubled in price · 2:15 Thirty seconds in your hand · 4:30 Your phone fakes the touch · 6:30 The cousins · 7:35 Impact on you · 8:40 Spot it yourself

• **Reels:**

1) 0:25–1:35 · "Same mug. Double the price."
2) 2:15–3:25 · "Why Apple wants you to touch it"
3) 3:50–4:30 · "Decathlon lost ₹65 crore doing this" (angle B hook)
4) 4:30–5:50 · "Your phone makes you pay 50% more" (angle C hook)
5) 7:35–8:40 · "The rule that beats the Apple store"

• **Creator to supply:**

• Screenshots: N1 (Inc42), N3 (Entrackr), N4 (Medianews4u), Warby Parker article (eMarketer)

• B-roll: Apple store interior with laptops (licensed stock or your own visit to BKC/Saket); Decathlon play zone (self-shot is best, and fits the topic); person swiping a shopping app; mattress unboxing; car showroom

• Optional: your own 10-second clip holding an iPhone in a store, as a punch-in for Ch. 2

• **Still NEEDS SOURCE / handle with care:**

• F1 screen angle: keep "reportedly" / "retail watchers say", never state as Apple fact

• R1 exact $7.12/$2.87 not used; script says "about seven / about three" ✓

• R4, R5, R15 are secondary, and the script names the study each time; verify the primaries before /final-check

• R11 is Myntra's own figure (script says "Myntra says") ✓

• Test-drive and Lenskart conversion numbers deliberately left out (not verified)

Instagram Reel — Why Apple WANTS you to touch its iPhones

Format: 9:16 · Target: ~60 s (~145 words, a touch faster than YouTube) · Style: STYLE.md v1.1, "turned up"

Rules applied: hook in the first 3 s · a visual change at least every 3 s · captions ≥96 px, 2–4 words a line, one highlighted word per line · keep text out of the Reels UI zones · end on the A/B question + "full video on YouTube".

A standalone Reel that tells the whole story in a minute. It's filmed on its own (vertical, to camera).

The five `[REEL n]` cut-downs tagged in SCRIPT.md are extra Reels cut later from the YouTube edit.

References (R#/F#) point to RESEARCH.md.

Time	SAY	ON SCREEN (a change every ≤3 s)
0:00–0:03	"This is why Apple lets you touch every single iPhone."	Hook card: **"Why Apple WANTS you to touch it"** · hand reaching for a phone on a store table · SFX whoosh
0:03–0:07	"In 1990, researchers gave coffee mugs to half a class. At random."	Classroom animation, mugs drop onto half the desks · caption highlight "at random"
0:07–0:12	"Owners wanted about seven dollars to sell. Buyers offered about three. Same mug." R1	STAT slams in: **$7 vs $3** · red circle on $7 · ping
0:12–0:16	"It's called the endowment effect. Once it feels like yours, it's worth more."	Text card: **"Mine = worth more"** · highlighter sweep on "yours"
0:16–0:20	"And you don't even have to own it."	Punch-in on you · soft hit
0:20–0:25	"Hold a mug for thirty seconds instead of ten, and people bid more for it." R3	Two hands, timers **0:10 vs 0:30**, the 30-second bid tag shoots up
0:25–0:29	"So Apple keeps every iPhone out. Unlocked. No box."	B-roll: Apple store table, phones out
0:29–0:33	"Decathlon puts cricket nets inside the store. Hit three shots, and it's *your* bat."	B-roll: Decathlon play zone · caption highlight "your bat"
0:33–0:38	"Online? Your phone fakes it. Touchscreen shoppers valued products about fifty percent more than mouse users." R4	Finger swipes a product on a phone · STAT **~50% more**
0:38–0:42	"And notice the app says *your* bag. Not 'the' bag."	Mock app header **"Your Bag (2)"** · red-pen underline on "Your" · pen scratch
0:42–0:46	"That's the trap. Thirty seconds, one swipe, and your price goes up."	"Willingness to pay" meter climbs
0:46–0:51	"The fix? The 24-hour rule. Put it down. Decide tomorrow."	Text card: **"The 24-hour rule"** · meter drops
0:51–0:56	"So, is this clever selling or manipulation? Comment A or B."	POLL card: **A: Clever selling · B: Manipulation** · pop, pop

0:56–1:00	"Full breakdown's on my YouTube."	End card: **"Full video on YouTube ↗"** + follow prompt · red-pen arrow

Spoken words: ~145 · **Runtime:** ~60 s

On-screen text sources (small source line under each stat)

- $7 vs $3: Kahneman, Knetsch & Thaler, 1990 R1
- 10 s vs 30 s: Wolf, Arkes & Muhanna, 2008 R3
- ~50% more: Brasel & Gips, via Boston College (R4, secondary; check the primary before /final-check)

Caption draft (the full post package comes in /video-post)

Apple lets you touch every iPhone for a reason. 🧠

30 seconds in your hand and your brain starts calling it "mine", and "mine" is worth more.

It's called the endowment effect, and your shopping app uses it too ("Your bag" 👀).

Clever selling or manipulation? Comment A or B 👇

Full breakdown on YouTube (link in bio).

Filming notes

- Shoot vertical (9:16), chest-up, eye level. Keep your face in the middle third; Instagram's buttons cover the right edge and the bottom ~20%.
- Speak a little faster than for YouTube, with a short pause after each stat so the card can land.
- If you can, film a 3-second clip of your own hand picking up a phone (store or home) for the opening shot.